Hacker Guide

UCSC AI Hackathon @ SF Tech Week

WHEN	WHERE	QUESTIONS
Sat Oct 10 – Sun Oct 11 Doors open 10:00 AM Saturday	**UCSC Silicon Valley Campus** 3175 Bowers Ave, Santa Clara, CA 95054	**Discord** discord.gg/s3Y6shpckU

Before you arrive

- **Join Discord and verify.** Go to discord.gg/s3Y6shpckU, open **verify-here**, tap Verify me, and enter the email you applied with. All announcements happen there.
- **Read the track challenges.** Each sponsor's full challenge is posted on Discord. Pick a track before Saturday so you can hit the ground running.
- **Read the Participant Agreement.** You agree to it at check-in. It covers conduct, safety, and judging rules.
- **Under 18?** A parent or guardian must sign the agreement. Bring the signed copy to check-in.
- **Pre-event workshops.** AMD and Cisco are hosting pre-event workshops. Times and links will be posted on Discord.
- **Plan your ride home Saturday night.** The venue closes at 10:00 PM and there is no overnight stay. Travel and lodging are not covered.

What to bring

Government or school photo ID that matches your registration, your laptop and charger, any hardware your project needs, and a water bottle.

Schedule

SATURDAY, OCT 10

10:00 AM	Doors open, check-in and breakfast
11:00 AM	Opening ceremony
12:00 PM	Hacking Begins
12:30 PM	Team formation
1:30 PM	Lunch Provided by ASUS
Afternoon	Sponsor workshops More information will be sent in the Discord
7:00 PM	Dinner Provided by ASUS
10:00 PM	Venue closes No overnight stay

SUNDAY, OCT 11

9:00 AM	Venue reopens
9:30 AM	Breakfast
1:30 PM	Submissions due on Devpost Then lunch, and set up at your table
2:00 PM	Judging starts Starts sharply at 2:00 PM
3:45 PM	Hardware returns All borrowed hardware back to the hardware desk
4:00 PM	Finals
5:15 PM	Awards ceremony
6:00 PM	Event ends

Times can shift. Discord has the latest schedule.

Tracks

Pick one track for your project. Each one is led by a sponsor who wrote the challenge, runs a session on their stack, and picks the track winners. The full challenge for each track is posted on Discord.

CLOUD AI · LED BY CISCO

Agentic workflows that live in the cloud. Orchestration, tool use, and multi-agent systems at scale.

Good fit if: your idea needs more than one machine, or has to call other services.

LOCAL AI · LED BY ASUS

AI that runs on hardware you can carry. Projects in this track must be built on an ASUS Ascent GX10, which comes pre-loaded with NVIDIA Nemotron.

Good fit if: latency, privacy, or working with no network is the point.

PHYSICAL AI · LED BY AMD

Agents with bodies. Robotics, robotic arms, and machines that act on the world.

Good fit if: the demo only lands when something actually moves.

Hardware

ASUS is providing GX10 systems and ZenScreen portable monitors for checkout, plus a hands-on PC build activity. AMD is providing SO-101 robot arm kits for hands-on prototyping, AMD Ryzen™ AI PC for on-device edge inference, and AMD Cloud access with AMD Radeon™ R9700 AI Pro GPUs for model training. Hardware is on loan and stays at the venue. Check it out at the hardware desk with your badge. **Return everything to the hardware desk once your judging is done on Sunday.**

Teams and submissions

- **Teams** have up to four people. Solo is fine. Use the 12:30 PM mixer or Discord to find teammates.
- **Submit on Devpost by 1:30 PM Sunday.** The Devpost link is shared on Discord. Add your **table number** to your submission. Late submissions are not judged.
- Every team member should be able to explain how the project works. A team that cannot explain its own submission will not be placed.

How judging works

Each team will get a chance to pitch to **a group of judges.** More information will be on Discord.

- **Judging starts sharply at 2:00 PM.** Each pitch is **3 minutes of presentation** and **3 minutes of Q&A**. A workshop on how judging works will be held as well.
- **Stay at your tables until judging is over.**
- **Top teams go to the finals** and pitch again.

What judges look for

Technical execution	Does it work? How hard was it to build, and how well is it built?
Creativity	Is the idea original, or a fresh take on a known problem?
Impact	Would people actually use this? Does it solve a real problem?
Demo and presentation	Can you clearly explain the problem, your solution and how it works?

Prizes

Prizes will be announced at the opening ceremony.

Sponsor credits

Several sponsors are giving every hacker free credits. Codes and claim steps are shared at the event. Please don't post the codes publicly.

SPONSOR	WHAT YOU GET

ElevenLabs	1 month of the Creator plan
Beeceptor	$25 toward the Team plan, 30 days
NVIDIA	$25 in Brev GPU credits
n8n	1 month of n8n Cloud Pro

At the venue

- Wear your badge where it can be seen. Bags may be checked at the entrance.
- You can come and go during open hours. Everyone must leave by 10:00 PM Saturday.
- Wi-Fi details are given at check-in.
- First aid is at the information desk. For emergencies, call 911, then tell an organizer.
- Need help? Find anyone in an organizer badge or post in Discord.

Co-Hosted by hack.dev with the UCSC GenAI Center and Baskin Engineering.